



Context Lab: Meanings Beyond One Sentence

Grade 5 • Ohio • Vocabulary

L.5.4

Infer and verify a word meaning using surrounding context. Includes 16 practice tasks, a four-task exit check, two explained models, and complete answer guidance.

PRINT • TEACH • REVISIT



Plan a focused lesson

Level and alignment

Grade 5 • Ohio • Vocabulary; L.5.4. Focus: Infer and verify a word meaning using surrounding context.

What is included

One cover; one teacher guide; one mini-lesson with two explained models; 1 original text/reference section(s); 16 practice tasks on four pages; one four-task exit check; four answer-key pages covering all 20 tasks; two access/source/license pages. Student texts are original, not extracted from released tests.

Time and sequence

Two 30–40-minute sessions plus a 10–15-minute exit check; extended writing or speech rehearsal may take longer. Model first; use tasks 1–4 to check readiness; practice the remainder in short groups; give tasks 17–20 without the key.

Preparation

Print student pages separately from teacher pages. Provide pencils and extra paper; oral-response learners need an adult recorder. Review word meanings and prerequisite decoding or sentence skills. No paid app, novel, or external reading is required.

Student directions

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.



Learn the move

Read before and after the target word. Look for examples, contrasts, causes, and explanations. Substitute a possible meaning and reread. Context may narrow a meaning without proving it; use the supplied mini-glossary for final verification. Focus is the context strand of the revised 2026 standard, not every strategy in the full standard.

Model 1 • The fragile tile broke when a spoon tapped it. What does fragile mean?

Easily broken. The light tap causing a break supports that meaning.

Model 2 • Is “colorful” a supported meaning for fragile?

No. The sentence describes breakability, not color.

Try the task first. Then compare the reasoning, not just the final word.



Verification glossary

reluctant: unwilling or hesitant; ample: more than enough; scarce: in short supply; precise: exact; temporary: lasting a limited time; sturdy: strongly built; revise: change to improve; dormant: inactive for a time; abrupt: sudden; brisk: quick and energetic. Use the glossary after attempting a meaning from clues.



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.

1. Nia was reluctant to step onto the stage. She stayed at the doorway until her partner offered to begin. Infer reluctant and cite a clue.

2. We packed ample paper. Even after everyone made two posters, half the stack remained. Infer ample.

3. Water was scarce at the camp. Each group received only a small container. Infer scarce.

4. The cut had to be precise. A crooked edge would stop the parts from fitting. Infer precise.



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.

5. The temporary sign stayed up for one afternoon. A permanent metal one arrived next day. Infer temporary.

6. The sturdy shelf held every heavy box without bending. Infer sturdy.

7. Jae will revise the instructions. Several readers missed the same step, so he plans clearer wording. Infer revise.

8. The club remained dormant during the holiday. Meetings began again in autumn. Infer dormant here.



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.

9. The music ended abruptly. One moment it played; the next, silence. What does abruptly mean?

10. We took a brisk walk, moving quickly enough to arrive before the bell. Infer brisk.

11. In item 3, would abundant fit scarce? Explain.

12. In item 4, could precise mean expensive? Explain.



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.

13. Verify reluctant and temporary using the glossary; name each supporting clue.

14. Write a two-sentence context for sturdy without using strong.

15. Write a contrast context for scarce using plenty in the second sentence.

16. Explain why a guessed meaning should be reread in the sentence.



Exit check • Apply the skill

Try without the answer key. Show evidence or reasoning when asked. Use separate paper for longer responses.

17. The route was temporary: workers reopened the usual road on Friday. Infer temporary and cite a clue.

18. Tess gave precise directions: turn left at the second gate, not the first. Explain precise.

19. The stack was ample; every team took ten sheets and many remained. Explain ample.

20. Write an original context for revise and explain the clue you used.



Answers and response criteria

1. Hesitant/unwilling; staying at the doorway is a clue.
2. More than enough; much remained after all used it.
3. In short supply; only a small amount per group.
4. Exact; fit depends on the edge's accuracy.
5. Lasting a limited time; contrast with permanent and one afternoon.

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Answers and response criteria

6. Strongly built; supports heavy weight.
7. Change to improve; plans clearer wording after a problem.
8. Inactive for a time; meetings paused and resumed.
9. Suddenly; immediate shift. It is the adverb form of abrupt.
10. Quick and energetic; moving quickly is explicit support.

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Answers and response criteria

11. No. Abundant means plentiful, opposite to the small supply described.
12. No. Accuracy/fitting is supported; no price information appears.
13. Reluctant=hesitant (doorway); temporary=limited duration (one afternoon).
14. Example: The sturdy stool held the heavy pot. Its legs did not wobble. Require meaning-revealing clue.
15. Example: Glue was scarce today. Yesterday we had plenty. Contrast must clarify shortage.

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Answers and response criteria

16. To check that it fits grammar, surrounding details, and overall meaning; guesses can be unsupported.
17. Limited duration; usual route returns Friday.
18. Exact; specific gate and direction remove ambiguity.
19. More than enough; all teams supplied and surplus remains.
20. Requires changing something to improve it, e.g., instructions corrected after feedback, plus explanation.

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Access and next teaching steps

AIG

Ask for a counterexample, an alternative supported interpretation, or a newly written item with an explanation. Add depth rather than speed.

504

Follow the individual plan: breaks, enlarged print, extra time, reduced copying, or an alternative response method as documented. These are classroom options, not a statement of permitted test accommodations.

EC

Follow the IEP; show one task at a time, model the first decision, and permit dictated reasoning when appropriate. For decoding practice, distinguish an adult-read direction from an adult-read target word.

ESL

Preview task verbs and key vocabulary, allow home-language planning, and offer “My answer is ___ because ___.” Evaluate the targeted skill separately from unrelated language errors. For French, retain the target French sentence while explaining directions in a familiar language.

Use the exit evidence

For each exit task, record 2 = accurate and complete for the stated prompt; 1 = partly accurate or missing a requested explanation; 0 = not yet demonstrated. Total 0–8 is a local teaching note, not a standardized score. For oral tasks do not penalize spelling or handwriting. Revisit the exact type of error rather than assigning a diagnostic label.

Next lesson: model one missed decision, let the learner try a new example, and compare the explanation. Extend only after the learner can explain the targeted skill.

Alignment, sources, and license

The objective is original wording describing a focused part of the cited standard; this is not a full curriculum or official practice test. Uses the current 2026 revised standard; no claim is made that existing released tests have been updated to this revision.

Official state standard • accessed September 15, 2026

<https://education.ohio.gov/getattachment/Topics/Learning-in-Ohio/English-Language-Art/English-Language-Arts-Standards/2026-Revised-ELA-Standards-K-12.pdf.aspx?lang=en-US>

Research limit: official released-assessment retrieval was unsuccessful in this run. This packet is standards-focused classroom instruction; it makes no released-test alignment, timing, or scoring claim.

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